



**SK 2212 Quality of Government in Comparative Perspective**

**Course Report V24**

**Course coordinators: Professor Marina Nistotskaya**

## **Organization of the course**

SK 2212 is a 15 credit-course open to students from all programs at the department of Political Science.

In Spring 2024, the course had 24 registered students, including three who re-enrolled. Seven students completed the course with a high pass (VG), while eight achieved a pass (G). Nine students have not yet completed the course: seven of whom failed to submit one of the three required written assignments, while two have not submitted any assignments.

The V24 course consisted of ten lectures, six group seminars, and individual tutorials. All learning activities were conducted in person.

The course was taught by five instructors: Professor Victor Lapuente, Professor Marina Nistotskaya, Georgios Xezonakis, and Mattias Agerberg. Additionally, a guest lecture was delivered by the head of Transparency International Georgia Eka Gigauro as a lead-up to the seminar on the eradication of corruption in Georgia. Georgios and Marina served as seminar moderators for the same group of students throughout the duration of the course.

## **Student evaluation**

Of 24 students who took the course 12 filled in the survey questionnaire (50%). Appendix A reports the results of the student evaluation survey. The main takeaway from the evaluation is that, despite some criticism of some elements of the course, students felt that they improved their knowledge on the matter of quality of government. At the conclusion of the course, a peer evaluation was conducted by Frida Boräng and Anna Persson, and by a student representative. The course's organization and teaching materials were rated as being of very high scholarly and pedagogical quality.

## **Course coordinator reflection**

The V24 course was allocated 238 hours, which is a substantial increase compared to V23 (148 hours). The annual changes in the number of hours allocated to the course often requires adjustment to the organization of the course. For example, compared to V23, in spring 2024 we were able to allocate hours for individual tutorials, and offer a session on how to write a literature review.

Before the course began, the key course personnel, Victor, Georgios and I, held an internal evaluative session. During this meeting, we decided to allocate two seminars, rather than one, to the political explanations of QoG, further refining the course to better suit political science and IAGG students.

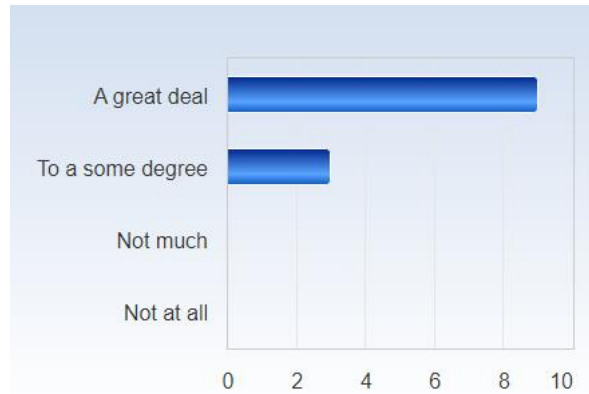
## Appendix A. Student evaluation: SK2212 V24

No of registered students: 24

No of respondents: 12

Response rate: 50%

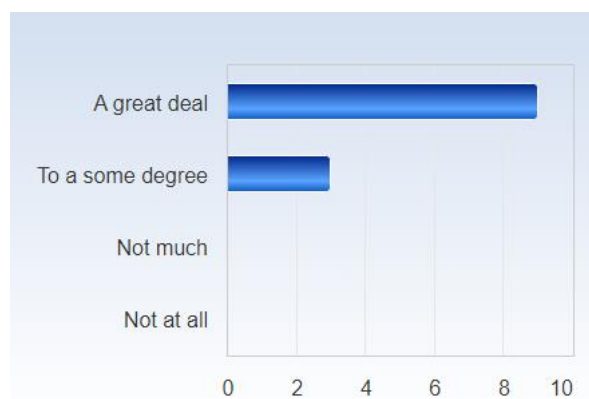
This course enhanced my knowledge of the role of quality of government on human well-being



How would you evaluate the role of the lectures in getting knowledge about the course's subject?



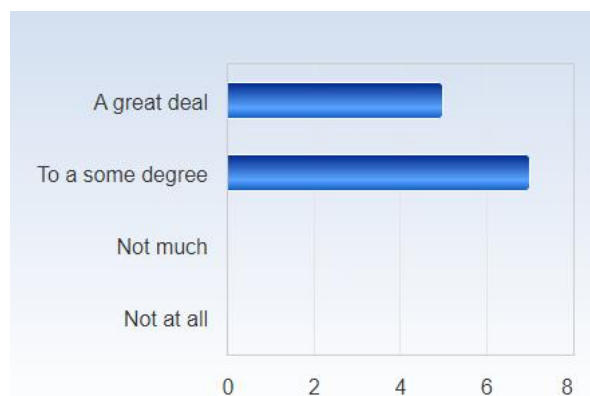
How would you assess the significance of assignments in acquiring knowledge about the subject of the course?



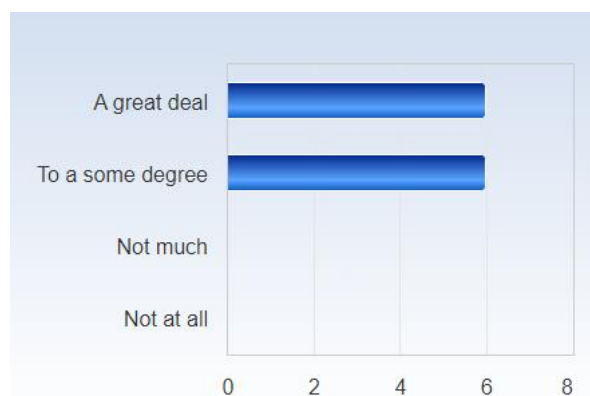
The feedback I receive on my assignments was consistently constructive and aided in refining my understanding of the subject matter.



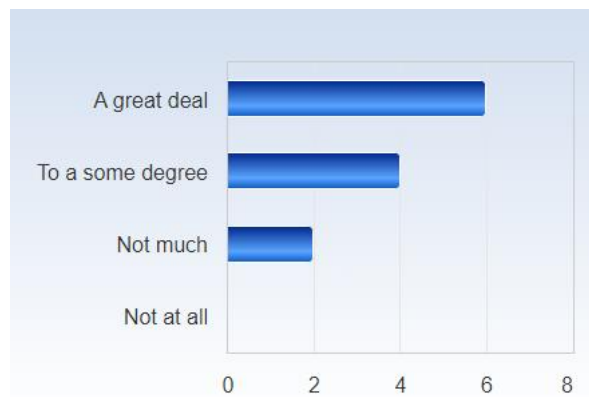
The course developed my ability to read and think critically



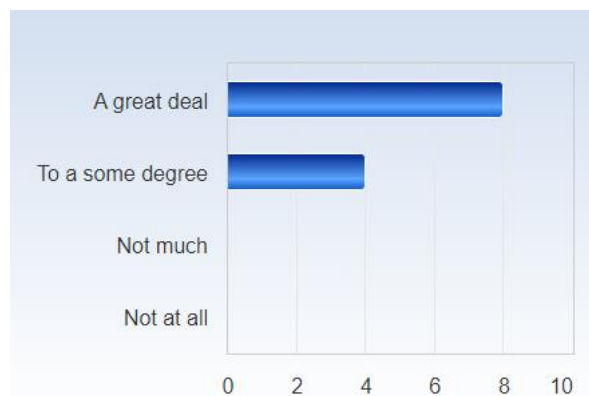
Through the course, I've developed a stronger capacity for evaluating arguments critically.



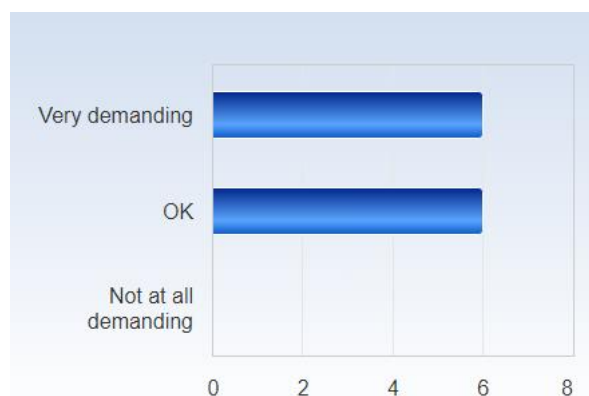
The course enhanced my skills in making persuasive arguments.



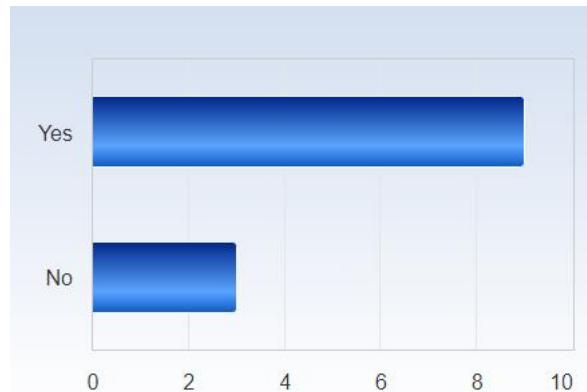
My interest in this field of study has grown since taking this class.



What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been asked to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:



Did you experience a 'eureka moment' during the course— a moment of sudden realization about something you previously didn't understand or weren't aware of? If yes, please provide a brief comment below.



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Comments on the "Eureka moment" question (original spelling)

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I used to believe that the quality of government and governance were interchangeable terms. However, after attending lectures, I've come to understand that they are distinct concepts, although closely intertwined, with each having an influence on the other

The Big Bang approach and that it is interesting to experiment with how information could be perceived

I didn't know that informal institutions could continue to have an impact long after the formal institutions they were based on are gone

To be honest, already in the beginning when we talked about the definition of QoG as impartiality. I thought QoG was closer to Good Governance than it is, but luckily (because Good Governance is too broad) it "simply" emphasizes the importance of impartiality in the exercise of public power (and meritocracy). Another eureka moment was some methodological problems which I first understood really good in this course, maybe because this course took place right after the method course

How "everything" can be traced to QoG and the importance of the policy implementation process in aspects of government. Before this course, the importance of the output-side of the political system was nothing that I had given any greater thought.

Maybe not a eureka moment per say, but I really enjoyed the lecture and seminar on Georgia – it was fascinating to get the chance to apply the theoretical knowledge I had gained throughout the course on a real world case. Also, it liked that so much of the beginning of the course was dedicated to understanding what the concept of QoG really entailed, it was really helpful for the rest of the seminars and assignments in the course.

No direct eureka moment, but I gained valuable insights into factors important to enhance governmental quality and a range of factors it then affects.

Learning about the Georgia case was extremely interesting. It was very valuable to see how the concepts of QoG can be translated into real situations.

Finding gaps in the literature and phrasing critique which we could voice in seminars, along side good and demanding discussions

Not necessarily a eureka moment but several new insights. My favorite lecture was "Corruption: theoretical approaches", it was filled to the max with information, very interesting and effective. I also really enjoyed the Georgia case.